

This is an incredibly challenging platformer, which is supposed to depict the challenges that one faces in life. However, you're encouraged to keep trying till you succeed, the game eggs you on, tells you to breathe, and says "You got this". You encounter several characters throughout your journey to the peak. Those that mock you, those that cheer you, and even a dark version of yourself – the voice in your



head that keeps telling you that you can't do it. Now you're thinking, this dark version of Madeline is probably the villain you vanquish at the peak. Quite the opposite, in fact. Madeline instead opens a conversation with her dark self, trying to get her to open up and rationalise with her, until both of them come to an agreement that. It drives home that it's okay to be scared, and that shouldn't stop you from chasing your dreams and taking risks.

Spiritfarer

Spiritfarer is a game about death. Quite a heavy topic. Your job is to ferry the souls of the dead to the afterlife. The souls that you ferry all have certain needs and wants, and you have the means to provide them. They could be something as mundane as a hug, to certain room requirements. You want the spirits to enjoy their final moments before they move on. The game teaches us



players that death is very much an important and essential part of the circle of life.

Hellblade: Senua's Sacrifice

Hellblade: Senua's Sacrifice was made in collaboration with neuro-scientists and with the help of people who experience psychosis. What we have here is a depiction of what people who struggle with psychosis go through. The symptoms, including PTSD, schizophrenia, anxiety, depression are all depicted. Senua struggles with psychosis, however, she believes it to be a curse that has been plaguing her village. She believes that she's being haunted by the "Darkness" and by voices in her head she calls



"Furies". The game depicts the journey through her perspective, as she navigates "Helheim" to save the soul of her loved one.

GRIS

GRIS is a play on many things. It literally means the colour grey in Spanish. It also sounds very similar to the word grief. Which makes sense considering the game follows the five stages of grief. The game follows a girl who has just lost her mother. The game starts with her



attempting to sing, but being unable to, which ends up removing all the colour from the world. She is in denial, but then the world turns red as she starts fuming. Then comes the bargaining, as the world around you starts turning green. But there's no reasoning with facts. The world then starts turning blue, as she slips into depression before finally becoming yellow, signifying acceptance. When she finally sings again, it is a melancholy tune, but the world is filled with life and colours again.

Spec Ops: The Line

Spec Ops: The Line is one of those games that invokes the, "are we the baddies?" question. On the surface, Spec Ops: The Line looks like any other war-based FPS game. But, the game breaks the fourth wall by directly questioning the morality of



those playing the game. Where do you draw the line? It's easy to get lost in the action of FPS games; it's mindless violence, and you get to play the hero. But Spec Ops: The Line turns all of that on its head, making you question your choices and decisions, making you wonder if it was all actually worth it. You can rationalise and say that you were just following orders, but you always had a choice. The game deals with issues of PTSD, guilt and regret, and is unlike any other FPS we've played before. *